

Darwin Core Maintenance Group call

2026-03-30

Attendees

13:00 UTC: Peter Desmet, John Wieczorek, Jörg Holetschek, Erica Kimmel, Cecilie Svenningsen, Tim Robertson

15:00 UTC: no new attendees

Regrets: Pieter Huybrechts, Paula Zermerglio

Notes:

- I. Brief discussion of potential regularly scheduled meeting time (day of week, UTC time, interval). This is also relevant to scheduling the May 11-22 working sessions.

JW: This may also be relevant to scheduled releases.

DECISION: First Monday 12:30 UTC, but not April 6 (public holiday).

- II. What will happen if we verify consensus? (Steve B.)
 - A. A final draft of the changed terms' metadata will be generated
 - B. Agreed upon changes (in tracker) will be made to the two documents ("DwC-DP Guide" and "DwC Conceptual Model") and a final draft will be generated.
 - C. The Executive Committee will be presented with these final drafts and a summary of the process leading up to their creation. They will be asked to ratify the changes.
 - D. After ratification, document and term metadata will be updated in the rs.tdwg.org repository and the two documents will be published in the dwc.tdwg.org website as documents that are part of the standard. The term changes will be incorporated in a new version of the List of Terms and Quick Reference Guide.
 - E. We should communicate with GSC to plan a mapping update.
 1. As soon as possible, mapping should be updated prior to the closing of the next public review.
 - F. We will have terms from a new namespace to synchronize (ac: - Audiovisual Core).
- III. Assessment of consensus on proposal under review
(<https://github.com/tdwg/dwc/issues?q=is%3Aissue%20state%3Aopen%20label%3A%22DwC-DP%20Public%20Review%22%20-label%3A%22Issue%20Summary%22%22>)
 - A. Issues or concerns related to individual term change proposals (entry by category:
<https://github.com/tdwg/dwc/issues?q=state%3Aopen%20label%3A%22Issue%20Summary%22%22>)

DECISION: The group decided that there was consensus on all new term and term change proposals.

- B. Issues or concerns related to the Conceptual Model document proposal (<https://github.com/tdwg/dwc/issues?q=is%3Aissue%20state%3Aopen%20label%3A%22DwC-DP%20Public%20Review%22%20label%3A%22Docs%20-%20Conceptual%20Model%22>)

DECISION: The group decided that there was consensus on the Conceptual Model document.

- C. Issues or concerns related to the Darwin Core Data Package Guide (<https://github.com/tdwg/dwc/issues?q=is%3Aissue%20state%3Aopen%20label%3A%22DwC-DP%20Public%20Review%22%20label%3A%22Docs%20-%20Data%20Package%20Guide%22>). Note that we are here assessing only the degree of support for the guide as it was under review (i.e., with the text stating that profiles will be served from rs.tdwg.org). There were 8 upvotes to leave this text and manage the profile and schemas according to John's proposal at <https://github.com/tdwg/dwc/issues/815#issuecomment-4035875769>. This discussion item does not include details of how profiles will be modified and managed.

DECISION 1: The group decided that there was consensus on the DwC-DP guide, including on the URL from which schemas should be served (rs.tdwg.org).

DECISION 2: The group (DwC MG) accepts the responsibility to manage the schemas. Including them as part of Darwin Core will be subject to another/later public review.

- IV. Status of the Mineralogy extension: state, timeline (Ben N.)
Could be ready for the next round of public review or the next following that. Depends if the focus will be on the schemas or the mineralogy extension
- V. Process and timeline for generation and review of the initial Darwin Core Data Packages profile and schemas (John W.)

SUGGESTION

Broad steps:

1. Release guide + conceptual model (the result of the current public review)
2. Release schemas at rs.tdwg.org as 1.0-RC.1 (cf. "It's approaching stability but be aware this is a prerelease", cf. [Camtrap DP](#))
3. Have public review
4. Release schemas at rs.tdwg.org as 1.0

Steps for 1:

- ☐ Update review page to show review is complete. Move to historical document location. Ask Matt what happens to MD in docs folder with respect to translations.
- ☐ John to make a PR at <https://github.com/gbif/dwc-dp> with guide + model updates
- ☐ John to make a PR at <https://github.com/gbif/dwc-dp> with schema updates

- ☐ Review by Peter, Tim, others
- ☐ Merge PRs
- ☐ Fork the [rs.tdwg.org](https://github.com/rs.tdwg.org) repo to update raw term and document metadata, then process in a branch. See notes [here](#).
- ☐ John to make a PR at <https://github.com/tdwg/dwc> with the dwc term changes based on branch in [rs.tdwg.org](https://github.com/rs.tdwg.org) fork.
- ☐ John to make a PR at <https://github.com/tdwg/dwc> with the two new guides
- ☐ Decide where the relationship explorer should go (dwc repo?)
- ☐ Decide where dwc-dp QRG should go (dwc repo?)
- ☐ Line everything up for a new DwC version (2026-04-xx) to be hosted at rs.tdwg.org
- ☐ Approval by MC
- ☐ Pull request from master of [rs.tdwg.org](https://github.com/rs.tdwg.org) fork containing raw data to TDWG [rs.tdwg.org](https://github.com/rs.tdwg.org) master. TDWG [rs.tdwg.org](https://github.com/rs.tdwg.org) maintainers process raw data, and generate new release of updated rs.tdwg.org
- ☐ Merge PRs if no change to underlying term and document metadata, otherwise update List of Terms document based on TDWG [rs.tdwg.org](https://github.com/rs.tdwg.org) metadata, then merge.
- ☐ News item
- ☐ Redirect <https://gbif.github.io/dwc-dp/> to dwc.tdwg.org.

Steps for 2:

- ☐ Copy schemas from <https://github.com/gbif/dwc-dp> to <https://github.com/tdwg/rs.tdwg.org> (either manually or another process)
- ☐ Decide which DwC Archive schemas are under DwC MG governance.
- ☐ Copy agreed upon DwC Archive schemas to rs.tdwg.org